AI UX Heuristic Evaluation

Dashboard System

https://swatisoni-ux.github.io/ai-ux-audit/Bad_UI.html
Audit date: September 8, 2026
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1. Executive Summary

The accessible page presents an account-settings interface inside a product branded as “Dashboard System.” Several clear usability risks are concentrated around system-oriented language, technical error communication, and conflicting status signals.

Confirmed findings: 4 — 2 High severity, 2 Medium severity. No Critical findings were established.

The highest-priority issue is the technical exception shown directly in the account-settings flow: “Critical Exception: ERR_HEX_0x002F89. Write access restricted.” This communicates an internal implementation state rather than a user-understandable problem and gives no visible recovery path. A second high-priority issue is the product language throughout the page, including “System Overlord Console,” “Node Lifecycle Sync Interval,” “terminal threads,” and a beta/version string, which makes the interface harder to understand in ordinary account-management terms.

Priority recommendations: translate system terminology into task-oriented language; replace technical error codes with plain-language explanations and next steps; reconcile the visible “System status: Operational” with the account-level write restriction; and make risky account actions explicitly safe to cancel/confirm before execution.

The permanent-delete button is not classified as a confirmed violation because the destructive action was not executed. Its behavior is documented as a validation point instead.

2. Audit Scope & Methodology

URL audited: https://swatisoni-ux.github.io/ai-ux-audit/Bad_UI.html
Page context: Account Settings within Dashboard System.

The audit used accessible page inspection plus review of the interface content exposed by the page. The accessible interface included primary navigation (Dashboard, Settings, Reports, Help), secondary account navigation (Profile, Account Settings, Notifications, Security), a Sync Database button, a username input, a visible exception message, a Danger Zone, and a permanent account-deletion button. The page also exposes a footer status of “Operational.”

Interaction testing status: The available inspection environment exposed page structure and controls but did not provide a reliable browser automation channel for executing arbitrary form submissions, destructive actions, keyboard traversal, or viewport resizing. Those areas are marked partial/not tested rather than inferred.

Framework: Nielsen’s 10 Usability Heuristics, using the supplied audit rubric for evidence, severity, confidence, false-positive control, and coverage.

3. Finding Summary

ID	Heuristic	Finding	Severity	Confidence
H2-01	H2 — Match Between System and Real World	System-oriented terminology obscures ordinary account tasks	High	High
H9-01	H9 — Error Recognition / Recovery	Technical exception gives no user-facing diagnosis or recovery	High	High
H1-01	H1 — Visibility of System Status	Global “Operational” status conflicts with visible write restriction	Medium	High
H8-01	H8 — Aesthetic / Minimalist Design	Technical/system framing competes with account-management content	Medium	High

H2-01 — System-oriented terminology obscures ordinary account tasks

Heuristic
Nielsen Heuristic #2 — Match Between System and the Real World

Severity
High

Confidence
High

Evidence
The page labels itself “System Overlord Console v4.2.1-beta” and tells users: “Current Node Lifecycle Sync Interval: 4000ms. Do not interrupt terminal threads.” The same account-settings page exposes ordinary tasks such as updating a username and syncing a database.

User Impact
Users managing an account must interpret internal/system concepts before they can understand what the product is doing or what they are expected to do. The language increases cognitive load and makes routine account actions sound like infrastructure operations.

Recommendation
Use user-facing concepts for account settings. For example, replace implementation-oriented lifecycle/thread language with a concise status such as “Data syncs automatically every 4 seconds.” Keep engineering/version information in an advanced or diagnostic area rather than the primary task context.

Evidence Image
No browser screenshot was captured in the available inspection environment. The finding is grounded in the accessible page content and exact UI text above.

H9-01 — Technical exception gives no user-facing diagnosis or recovery

Heuristic
Nielsen Heuristic #9 — Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Severity
High

Confidence
High

Evidence
Immediately below the username field, the page displays: “Critical Exception: ERR_HEX_0x002F89. Write access restricted.” No visible explanation identifies what the user should do next, whether the attempted operation failed, whether their input was preserved, or how to regain write access.

User Impact
A user encountering this state cannot diagnose the problem from the message. The hexadecimal error identifier is not meaningful in user terms, and “write access restricted” does not establish whether the issue is permissions, a temporary service state, an invalid action, or a system failure.

Recommendation
Replace the code-first message with a plain-language explanation tied to the affected task. State what failed, why it may have happened, whether the user’s input is safe, and the next available action.

Evidence Image
No browser screenshot was captured in the available inspection environment. The finding is grounded in the accessible page content and exact UI text above.

H1-01 — Global operational status conflicts with visible write restriction

Heuristic
Nielsen Heuristic #1 — Visibility of System Status

Severity
Medium

Confidence
High

Evidence
The page simultaneously presents “Critical Exception: ERR_HEX_0x002F89. Write access restricted.” and a footer stating “System status: Operational.”

User Impact
The two status messages describe materially different states without clarifying their scope. Users cannot readily tell whether the system is healthy but their account is restricted, or whether the page is in a degraded state.

Recommendation
Make status scope explicit. Distinguish “System: Operational” from “Account changes: Temporarily unavailable,” and place the task-specific state next to the affected action.

Evidence Image
No browser screenshot was captured in the available inspection environment. The finding is grounded in the accessible page content and exact UI text above.

H8-01 — Technical framing competes with account-management content

Heuristic
Nielsen Heuristic #8 — Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Severity
Medium

Confidence
High

Evidence
The account-settings page includes the prominent “System Overlord Console v4.2.1-beta” heading, a low-level sync interval, a warning not to interrupt “terminal threads,” a raw exception code, and a “Danger Zone,” while the core task is simply managing account settings.

User Impact
Relevant account controls compete with implementation/status information. Users must parse unrelated technical framing to find and understand the actions that matter to them, increasing visual and cognitive noise.

Recommendation
Prioritize account tasks and their current state. Move low-level diagnostic/version information into a secondary status or developer/administrator view. Keep the main settings page focused on settings, permissions, feedback, and recovery.

Evidence Image
No browser screenshot was captured in the available inspection environment. The finding is grounded in the accessible page content and exact UI text above.

4. Interaction Coverage

Area	Status	Notes
Visual UI	Tested	Accessible page content and task structure reviewed.
Navigation	Partial	Primary and secondary navigation labels inspected; route activation not reliably executable.
Forms	Partial	Username field and surrounding feedback inspected; submission behavior not executed.
Error recovery	Tested (state inspection)	Visible exception state reviewed; no recovery affordance was visible in the accessible page content.
Loading / processing	Partial	Sync interval/status copy inspected; live loading transition not observed.
Destructive actions	Not tested	Permanent account deletion was intentionally not executed.
Responsive	Not tested	No reliable viewport-resizing/browser automation channel available.
Keyboard	Not tested	No reliable keyboard traversal channel available.
Dialogs / overlays	Not observed	No dialog/overlay was exposed by the accessible page content.

5. Heuristic Coverage

Heuristic	Result
H1 — Visibility of System Status	1 confirmed finding (H1-01)
H2 — Match Between System and Real World	1 confirmed finding (H2-01)
H3 — User Control and Freedom	No confirmed violation observed; destructive action not executed
H4 — Consistency and Standards	No confirmed violation observed
H5 — Error Prevention	No confirmed violation observed; behavior not fully testable
H6 — Recognition Rather Than Recall	No confirmed violation observed
H7 — Flexibility and Efficiency of Use	No confirmed violation observed
H8 — Aesthetic and Minimalist Design	1 confirmed finding (H8-01)
H9 — Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors	1 confirmed finding (H9-01)
H10 — Help and Documentation	No confirmed violation observed

6. Prioritization

Priority	Finding	Recommended Action
1	H2-01 / H9-01	Replace system jargon and technical error codes with plain-language, task-oriented status and recovery g
2	H1-01	Separate global service health from account-level availability so users can understand exactly what is ope
3	H8-01	Move low-level diagnostic/version information out of the primary account-management experience.

7. Limitations

The audit could inspect the accessible page representation and identify controls, labels, error text, status text, and navigation structure exposed by the target URL. The available inspection environment did not support reliable end-to-end browser automation for arbitrary clicks, form submission, keyboard traversal, or viewport resizing.

The permanent “DELETE ACCOUNT PERMANENTLY” action was **not executed**. No claim is made about whether it has confirmation, undo, or recovery behavior. The Sync Database button and username form were also not submitted, so their post-action/loading/error behavior remains unverified.

No screenshot evidence was captured because the available web inspection channel exposed page content but did not provide a screenshot operation for this HTML page. Findings therefore use direct textual/UI evidence from the accessible interface. These limitations reduce coverage confidence for interaction-dependent heuristics but do not weaken the direct observations underlying the four confirmed findings.

8. Appendix — Observed UI Evidence

Primary navigation: Dashboard · Settings · Reports · Help

Page heading: System Overlord Console v4.2.1-beta

System copy: Current Node Lifecycle Sync Interval: 4000ms. Do not interrupt terminal threads.

Account navigation: Profile · Account Settings · Notifications · Security

Controls: Sync Database · Update Username [input] · DELETE ACCOUNT PERMANENTLY

Error/status copy: Critical Exception: ERR_HEX_0x002F89. Write access restricted. / System status: Operational

Source: target page inspected on September 8, 2026. The report records the exact observed page text and URL for traceability.